

CHANDIGARH | Fall From Glory

YASBANT NEGI



A.S. BINDRA WITH SON ABHINAV

In the matter of living up to the family name, A.S. Bindra has missed the mark. The leading Punjab industrialist and father of Beijing golden boy Abhinav was arrested by the Delhi Police's Economic Offences Wing and accused of defrauding Apple Finance and IndusInd Bank of a total of Rs 9.31 crore. Bindra Sr, managing director of Dera Bassi-based Punjab Meats Limited, had issued five cheques which were not honoured. As soon as he was arrested from his lavish Zirakpur farmhouse, he

complained of chest pain and was admitted to a hospital in Chandigarh, moving hospitals as his lawyers tried to obtain bail for him. The Delhi Police are now waiting at his bedside for the medical all-clear to bring Bindra to the capital.

by Arvind Chhabra

DELHI | Clean Return

Hardware companies are on the hunt for the best e-waste disposal mechanisms. The waste from discarded computers, TVs and mobiles is projected to grow to over 8,00,000 tonnes by 2012. After Wipro, Nokia and Philips, Hewlett-Packard's 'take back' allows customers to return HP printers, PCs, scanners, fax machines and recycle them locally. An e-waste legislation will soon be announced by the government in partnership with the Manufacturers' Association for Information Technology and other groups.

by Nandini Vaish



REUBEN SINGH

**INDIA'S
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Pink Again

If the famous 'pink chaddi' campaign got enough mileage, this next pink initiative should strike many chords. Estimating that more than 5 per cent of Indian IT and Information Technology Enabled Service (ITES) employees are threatened by job loss in the next two quarters, the United Professionals' Union has launched the 'Stop the Pink Slip' campaign for ITES employees. The campaign is estimated to run the whole of May in Bangalore and will start with a petition and signature campaigns to NASSCOM, the IT and ITES employer body.

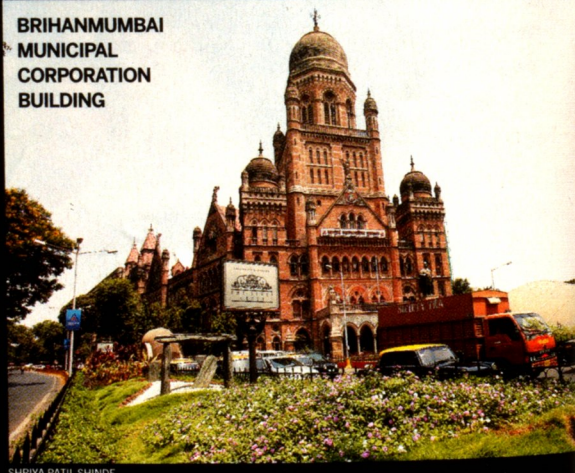
by Nirmala Ravindran

BMC-RUN SCHOOLS WILL OFFER THEIR STUDENTS ART, MUSIC, DRAMA AND SPORTS

MUMBAI | OFF COURSE

Humble government schools are on course to get trendy makeover. Students from the city's Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC)-run schools can now expect to hone their crick-eting skills with a little advice from master sportsmen or have renowned theatre actors teach them how to emote on stage. With a focus on "all-round education" for its students, the civic body will have swimming, art, music, drama and sports in all its schools. The extra-curricular classes, to begin this academic year, will be conducted by professionals and experts from various fields. As of now, cricketers Pravin Amre and Vinod Kambli, singer Abhijeet Sawant and actor Nana Patekar are on BMC's wishlist. "This will give a proper platform to our students and encourage development of various skills," says Abasaheb Jadhav, education officer, BMC. **by Aditi Pai**

BRIHANMUMBAI
MUNICIPAL
CORPORATION
BUILDING



SHRIYA PATIL SHINDE